

BEAUTY INFLUENCERS ARE OUR INSPIRATIONS



We can't give them advice with our "beauty" expertise...



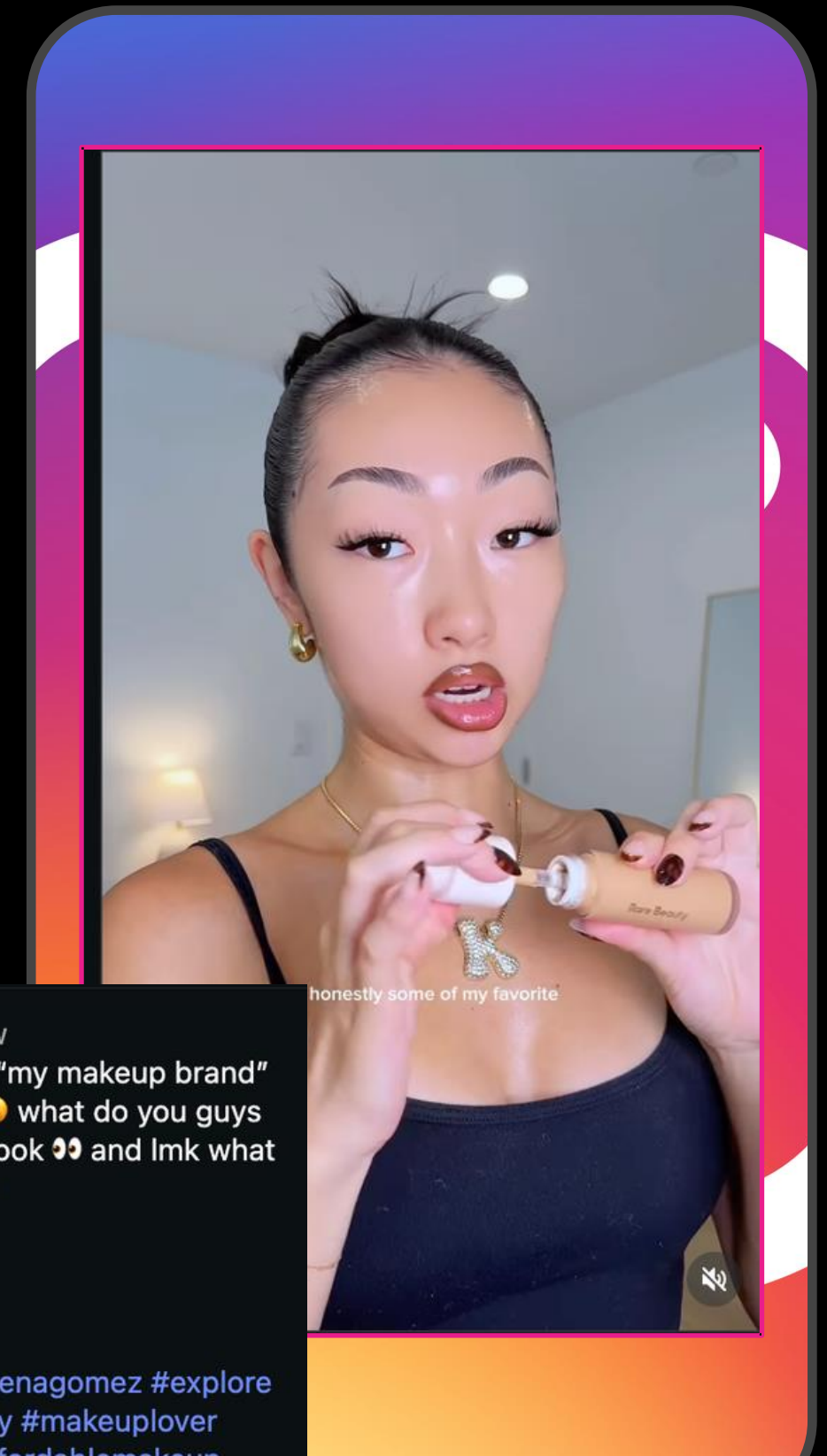
BUT WE CAN HELP INSTAGRAM BEAUTY INFLUENCERS WITH OUR **ANALYTICS SKILLS!**

WHAT MAKES A BEAUTY POST POP?

How to grow from Micro to Macro Beauty Influencer

by optimizing post engagement with data

9,821 instagram posts analyzed



itsbabykelz 21 w
sooo apparently "my makeup brand"
is @rarebeauty 🤔 what do you guys
think about this look 🤔 and lmk what
brand you get ✨

.
. .
. .
. .

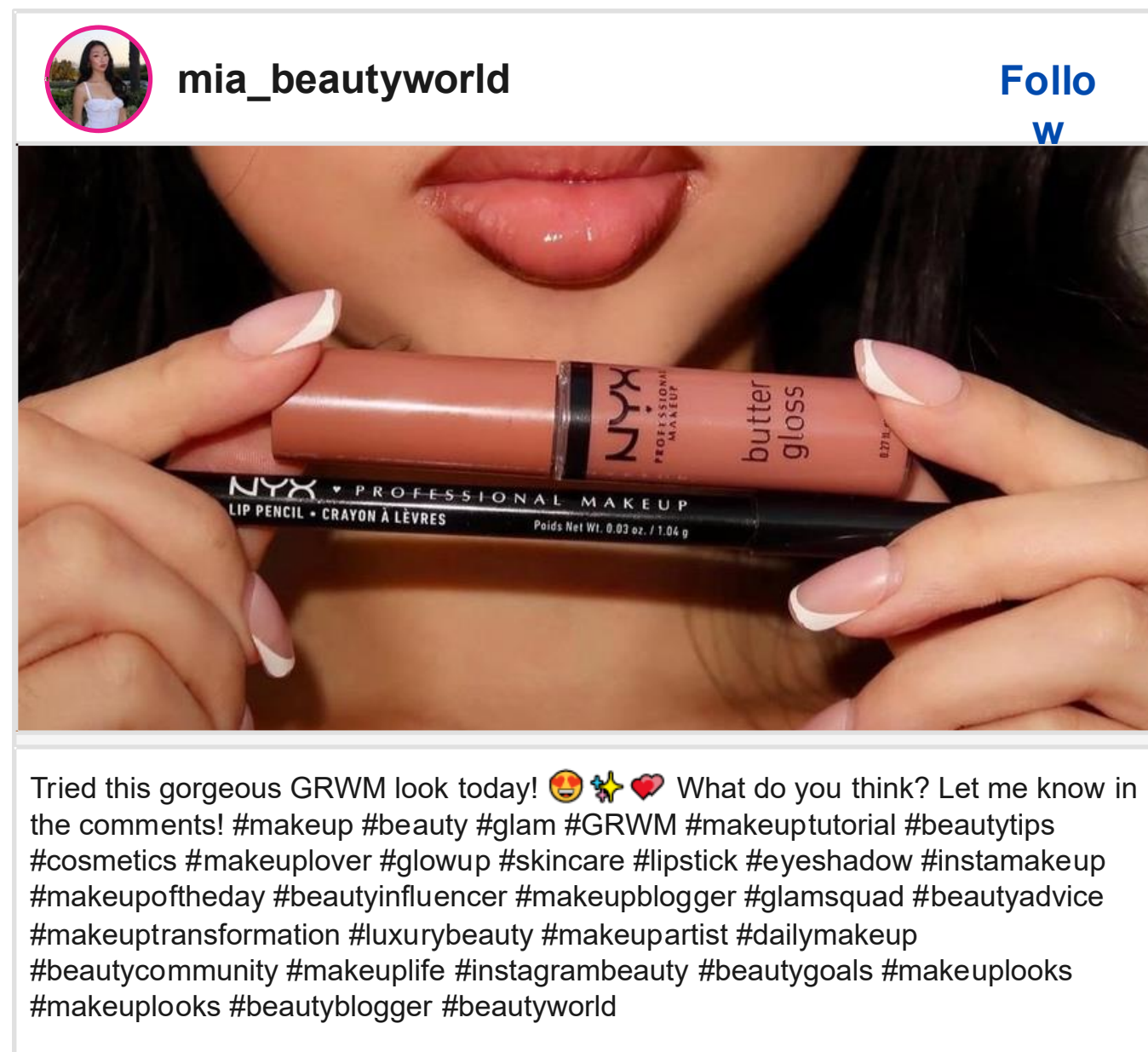
#rarebeauty #selenagomez #explore
#makeup #beauty #makeuplover
#makeupreel #affordablemakeup
#makeuphacks #makeuptutorial
#makeupideas #makeuplover
#makeuplook #itgirl #makeuphaul
#explorepage #viral #trending
#makeupchallenge #makeuptips

❤️ 45K 💬 182 📌
3 November 2025

MEET OUR INFLUENCER

Meet Mia. She's Doing Everything Right.

Or so she thinks...



Her Post Performance:



Likes

312

out of 8,400 followers



Comments

14

people engaged



Engagement

3.88%

but it could be better

The Problem:

Mia has 30 hashtags, a polished photo and a long caption, but she's still a **Micro Influencer**.

WHAT IS SHE MISSING?

9821 real Instagram posts from 1542 beauty influencers

We Asked The Data.

9,821

Real Instagram Posts

1,542

Beauty Influencers

3

Tiers Analyzed

username	post_id	timestamp	likes	comments	followers	engagement_rate	caption
jedan711	1829231107826494086	1532281362	178	0	7878.0	0.0225945671490225	#polaroids #digitals #model #nyc #newyorkcity #c
ooh.mee	1924310888064755426	1543615755	11475	66	202206.0	0.0570754577015518	29.11.18 🥰
swalina	1998155492636976847	1552418718	60092	0	450119.0	0.1335024737902640	child of the moon 🌙 @marieschmidtcom
glam.glimmers	1952382315867152792	1546962130	22576	478	484968.0	0.0475371570907771	@elysian360 Wow all that hair 🥰 Which one is yo
fays._	1791119100102367429	1527738057	35593	168	695865.0	0.0513907151530828	Bracitos de alambre, se tragaron una ciruela 🍷 c Miau miau miau 🐱 #gymshark #gymsharkwomen #brazosdehilo #me
sofielindgren.se	1713319431930930664	1518463613	791	22	10099.0	0.0805030201010001	Bara jag som älskar fjädrar? ✨ #interiordesign#de
donialuvsu	1697299609776220804	1516553902	3322	51	226598.0	0.0148853917510304	Filming a Q&A on our marriage 1 year later ! Com
kaysalbeautyxo	1886390934310327735	1539095344	125	0	2243.0	0.055728934462773	I think these lashes have become my favorite! 💕 Products used:



From Raw Data to Variables.

9 engineered features · 2 channels · 4 regression models

TEXT ANALYSIS

5 features

Text Cleaning

Lowercase · remove URLs, mentions · normalise whitespace

Effective Word Extraction

Language detection via langdetect · Google Translate API via deep-translator · Bag of Words · Differential word analysis

Sentiment Scoring using VADER

Lexicon-based NLP · compound score from -1 to +1 per caption

5 Variables Extracted

Sentiment score

Caption length

Hashtag count

Emoji count

CTA flag

IMAGE ANALYSIS

4 features

Image Extraction

189GB archive · JSON-Image mapping · 7-Zip batch extraction · 9,821 images

Libraries - PIL + OpenCV

Per-image feature computation across all 9,821 extracted images

4 Variables Extracted

Brightness Mean HSV value channel

Colorfulness Hasler & Suesstrunk (2003)

Face Presence OpenCV Haar cascade

Edge Density Laplacian variance

Introduce the Tiers of Influencers.



✓ MICRO

- Under 20K followers - 5,021 posts

Authentic, everyday creators



✓ MID

- 20K to 100K - 2,921 posts

Growing fast, starting to get brand deals, finding their niche



✓ MACRO

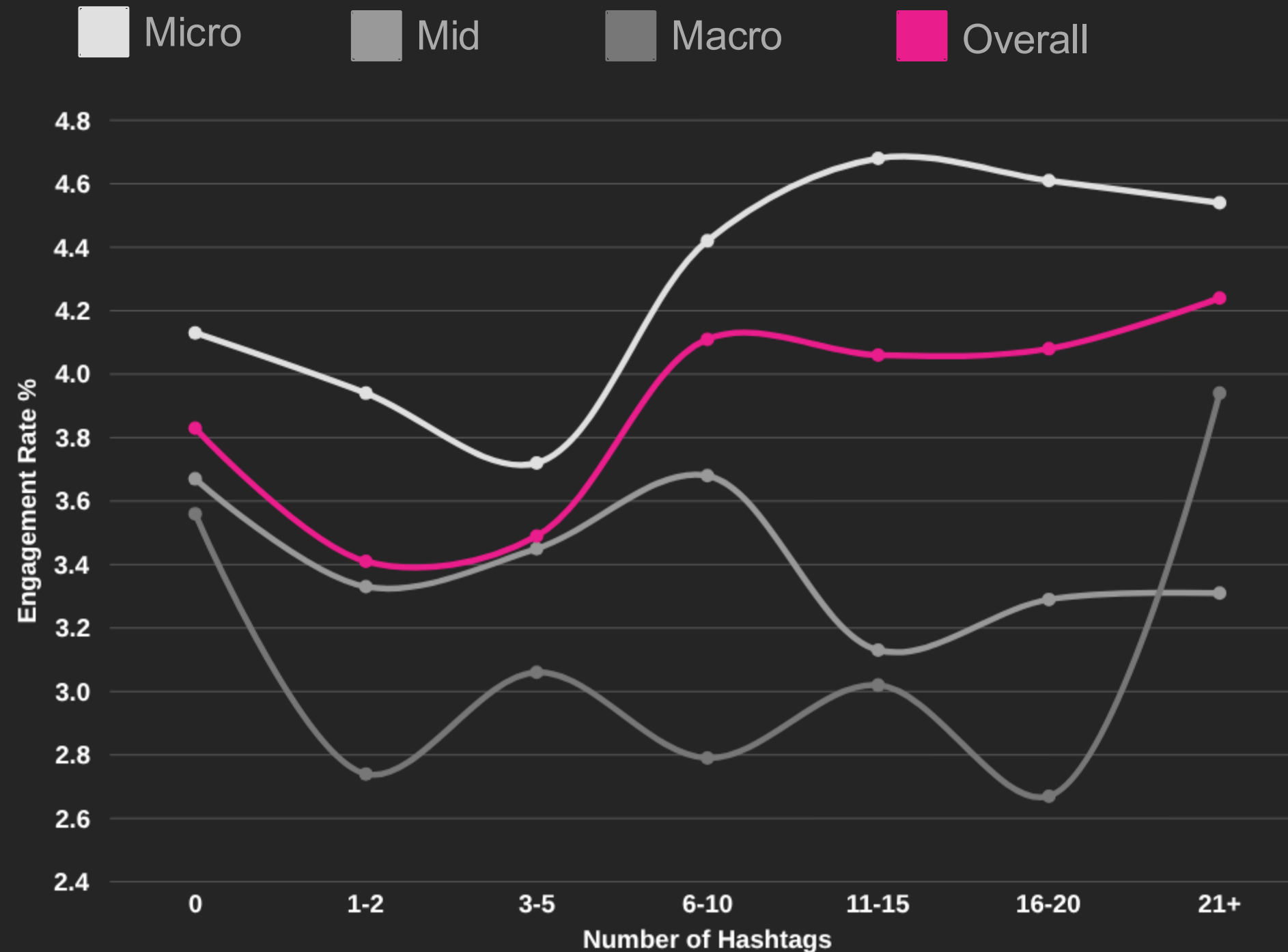
- Over 100K - 1,879 posts

The ones with ring lights, photographers, and a PR team

Our Data Predicted This.

Instagram Just Made It Official.

2019 Beauty Influencer Data



THEN: 2019

WHAT OUR REGRESSION FOUND

Hashtag count coefficient = -0.0002**

Hashtag counts show a non-linear relationship with engagement rate.

Micro: Clear sweet spot at 11-15, then plateau

Mid: Relatively flat, modest peak at 6-10

Macro: High baseline, but declines with more hashtags, organic reach does the heavy lifting

The Takeaway

Quality over quantity. Well-targeted hashtags outperform hashtag stuffing across all tiers

Mia's fix: Swap 30 generic for 5 targeted hashtags

#GRWMtutorial

#beautytransformation

#makeuptips

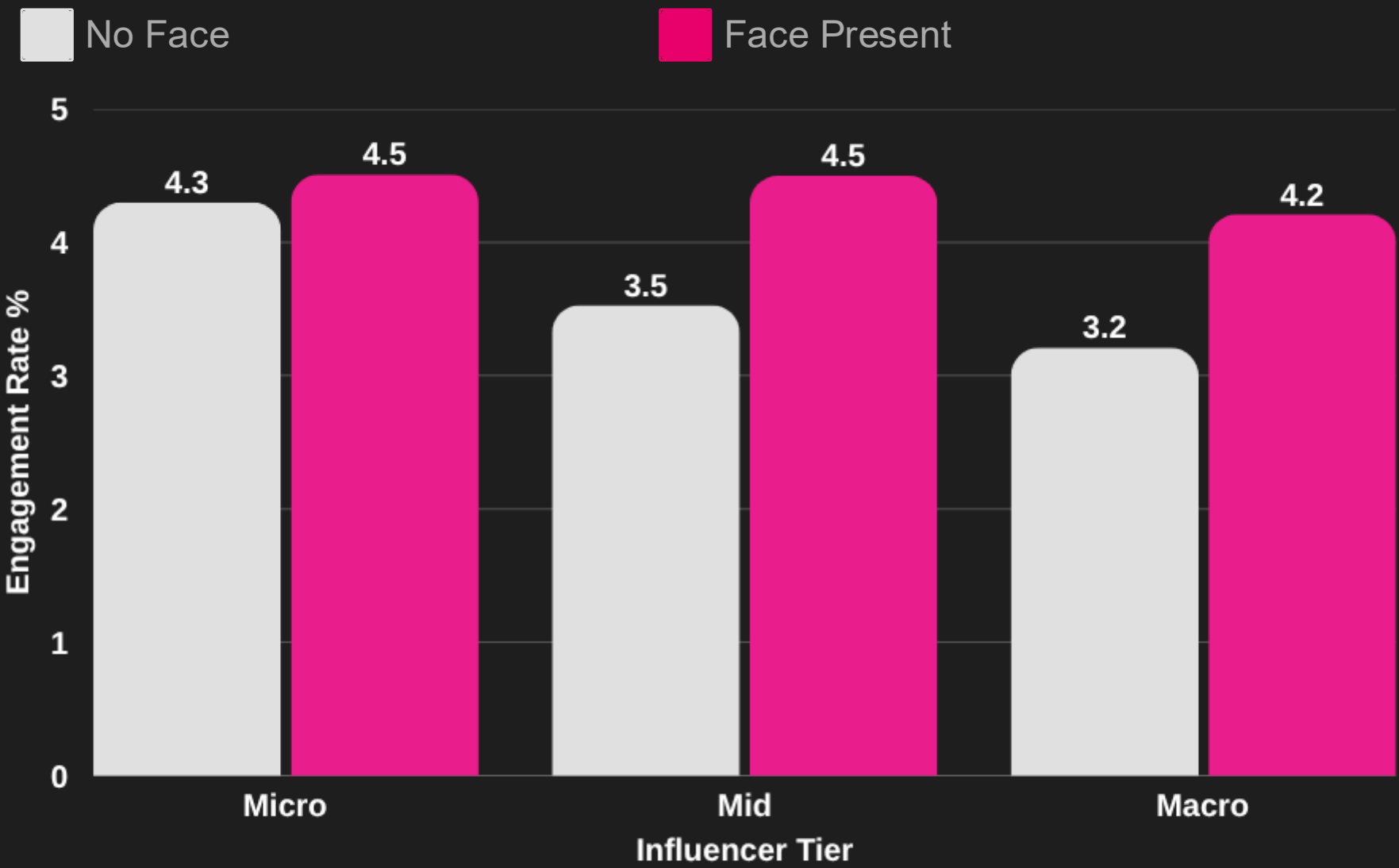
#kbeauty

#beautycreator

Show Your Face.

Face in Post?

Mean engagement rate: face VS no face by tier



THE TAKEAWAY

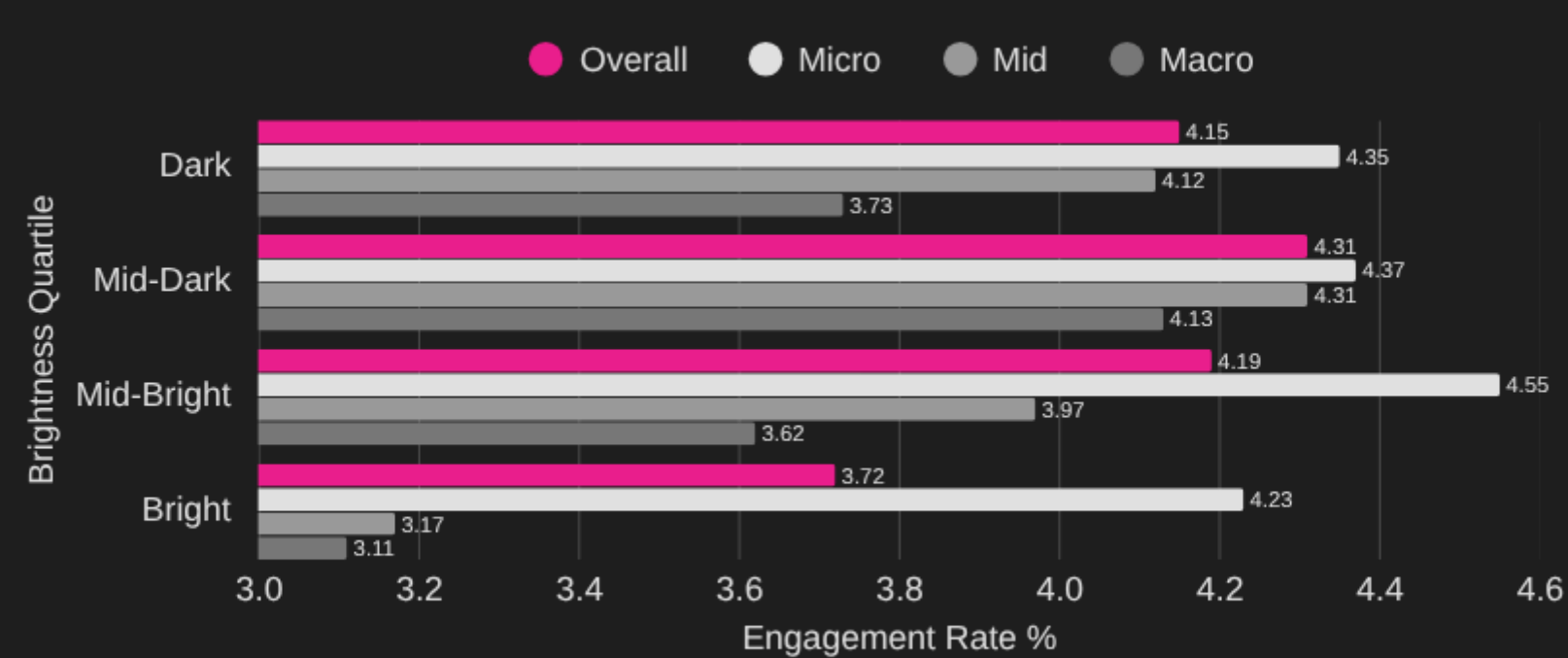
Posts featuring a visible human face achieve higher engagement rates than product-only or scenery posts. The engagement premium from face presence grows as influencers scale.

Light It Right. Corlorful but No Saturated

Two visual signals. Both statistically significant. Both easy to control.

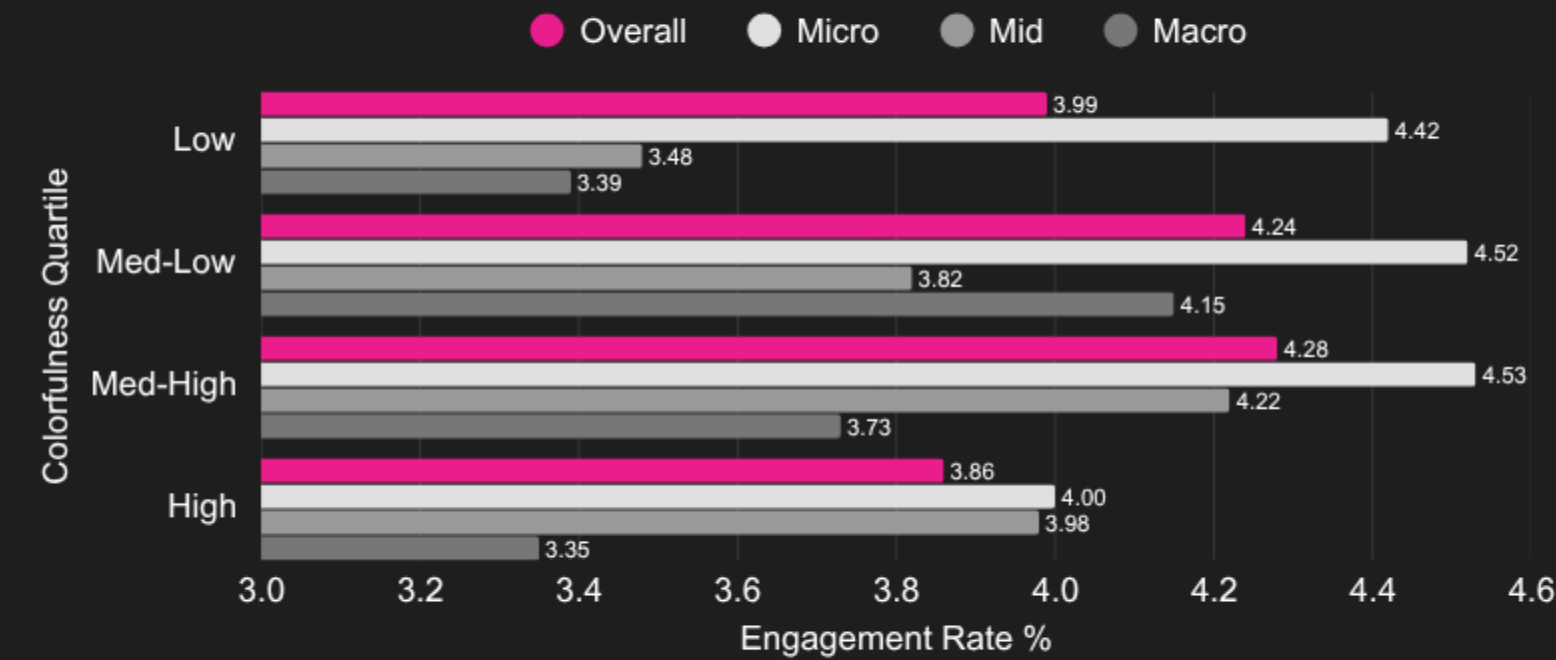
Brightness Level?

Engagement rate by brightness



Colorfulness?

Engagement rate by colourfulness

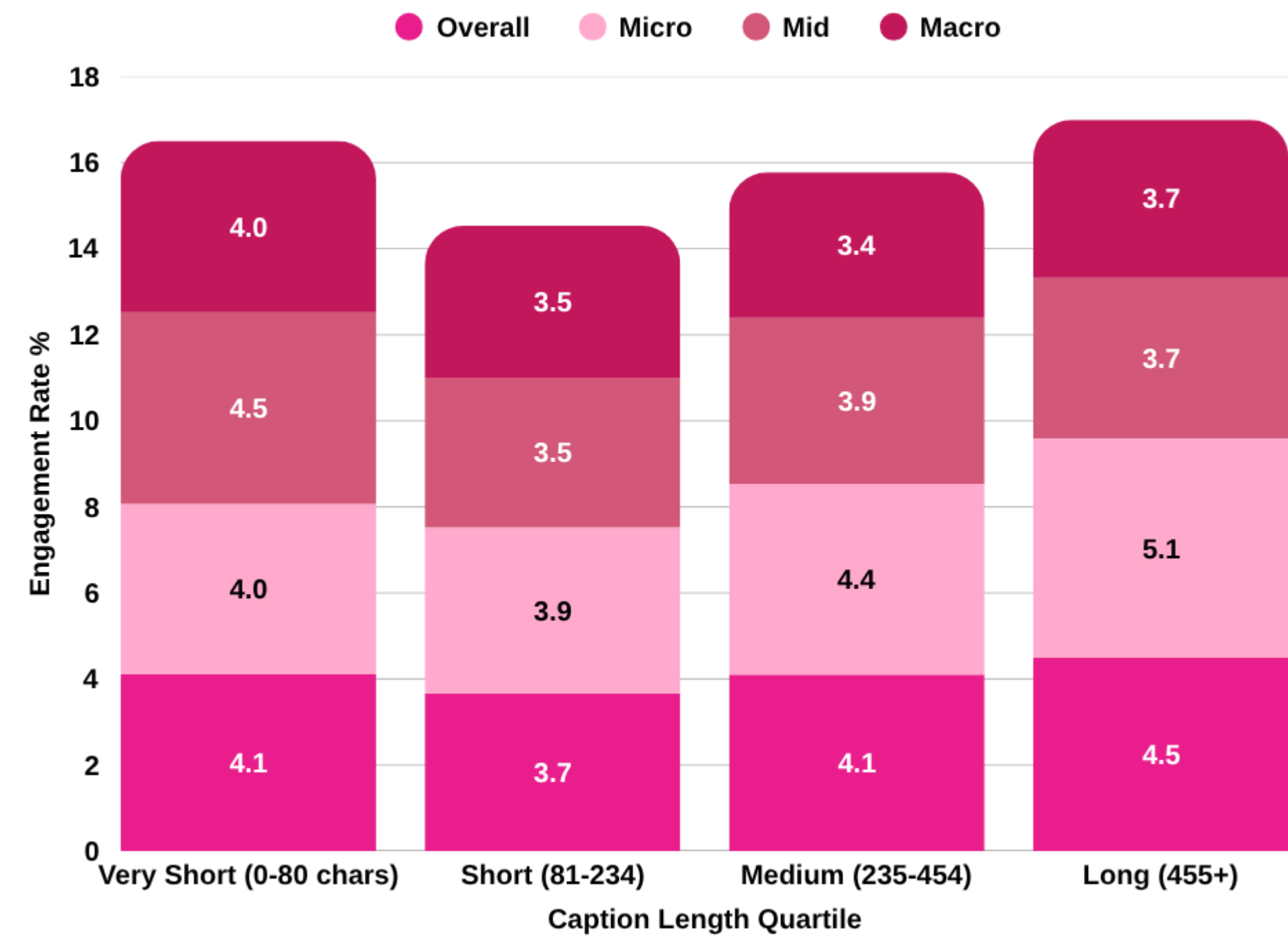


THE TAKEAWAY ‘natural but polished’

Mid-bright lighting and med-low colorfulness consistently outperform both extremes across all tiers. Over-filtered, oversaturated images signal inauthenticity. Audiences (and algorithms) reward images that feel real.

Mia's fix: Shoot in soft natural light, keep skin tones warm and true-to-life, and dial back the saturation.

Long Captions Win. Tone Matters Too.



Sentiment by Tier:

MICRO

Positive & upbeat tone performs best

MID

Neutral & raw tone outperforms positivity

MACRO

Bold, unfiltered opinions drive the highest engagement

Words that can boost captions:

MICRO

happiness · hydrating · base · cool · nice · recommend · believe · fine · ultra · weather

MID

steps · luck · flex · blossom · hype

MACRO

Hard to predict from words alone, audience size and brand authority dominate

Different Tier, Different Playbook.

Feature	TIER		
	MICRO	MID	MACRO
	< 20K followers	20K - 100K followers	> 100K followers
Hashtags	5 niche tags, max out the limit	3-5 mixed (niche + broad) tags	1-3 highly curated, or none
	* Instagram now limits all posts to 5 hashtags max (Dec 2025)		
Face in Post	Always	Always	Critical
Caption Length	Long & chatty	Medium to long, narrative	Short to medium, punchy
Brightness	Medium bright	Medium dark	Medium dark
Colorfulness	Medium low, natural tones	Medium high	Medium low
Sentiment	Warm & positive	Neutral / raw let the story speak	Direct & unfiltered skip the positivity

RECOMMENDATIONS

How to Go Micro to Macro ?

01 Show Your Face

Always include your face.
It's worth ~+1pp in engagement
and it builds community.



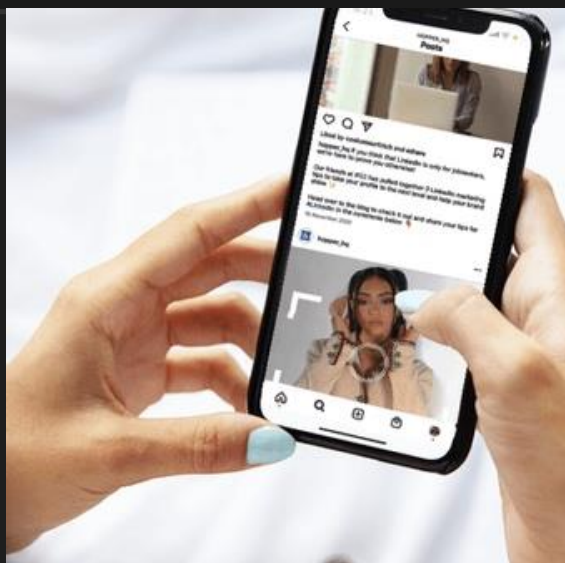
02 Light It Right

Medium brightness = maximum engagement
Overexposed = audience scrolls past



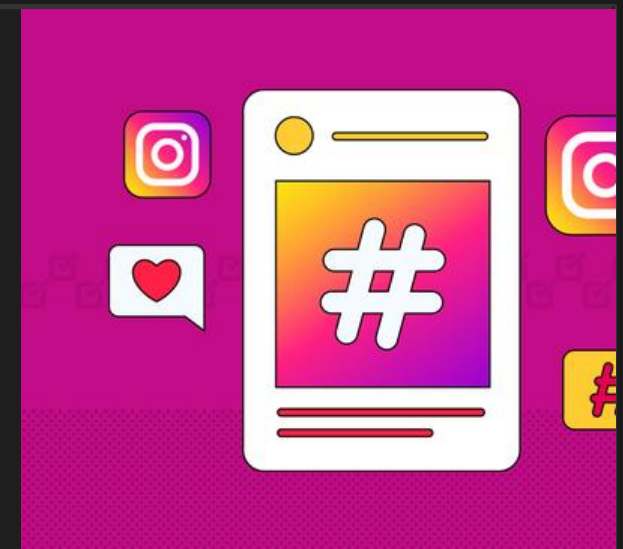
03 Write More

455+ characters outperform short captions.
Tell a story, add a CTA, be you.



04 Tag Strategically

5 Relevant hashtags in every post.
Mix niche + broad for discoverability.



WE MAKE OUR RECOMMENDATIONS EASY TO FOLLOW:

INSTAGRAM ENGAGEMENT OPTIMIZER TOOL



Instagram Engagement Optimizer
Made by social media analysts, for beauty influencers · Group 8

Powered by 9,821 post analysis

YOUR INFLUENCER TIER


Micro < 50k followers


Mid-tier 50k – 500k


Macro > 500k followers

 YOUR CAPTION

Paste your Instagram caption here — include hashtags and emojis...

0
CHARS

0
HASHTAGS

0
EMOJIS

—
CTA

 YOUR POST IMAGE


Click to upload or drag & drop
JPG · PNG · enables image-specific advice

Analyse My Post

MADE BY SOCIAL MEDIA ANALYSTS, FOR BEAUTY INFLUENCERS.

Thank You!

Q & A